

8.4 Publisher developer settings

To get started with Publisher, you first have to go to your application's Developer Settings page (www.facebook.com/developers/apps.php), choose your application from the list on the left and then click on Edit Settings. Go to the Profiles tab and look for the section titled Profile Publisher. The options here are used to specify the text for the links used to activate the Publishers and the URLs from which Facebook will pull their content. For the Publish Text value, enter the name of the application, i.e., Compliment. For the Publish Callback URL, enter something like http://example.com/<application_name>/publisher_callback.php, but be sure to use your own local URL. If you decide to use different values for the link labels, make sure its less than 20 characters.

8.5 Creating the publisher

Once you have set the necessary options in your applications' Developer Settings, you can actually implement the Publisher. Facebook communicates with the application when using a Publisher by actually requesting information from the Publisher Callback URLs on two separate occasions:

- When a user clicks a Publisher link in a profile or Home page, Facebook makes calls to request the FBML and display the Publisher.
- If a user then submits a story from that Publisher, Facebook calls it again to request the content for the Feed story it has to publish. Your callback's code determines which type of request Facebook makes by checking the value of the method POST variable, which Facebook sends with each call.

The five POST variables sent by Facebook that you'll come across when creating Publishers are:

`fb_sig_user` - Facebook ID of user interacting with the Publisher. It is always sent.

`fb_sig_profile_user` - Facebook ID of user from whose profile the Publisher was requested. It is always sent.

`fb_sig_session_key` - If sent, it means the user identified by `fb_sig_user` has authorized the application that provided the Publisher.

`app_params` - Contains an array of the Publisher's form variable data, keyed by form element name. It is only sent when method has the value `publisher_getFeedStory`.

Now that you can determine if the values of `fb_sig_user` and `fb_sig_profile_user` are equal, it is certain that the user interacting with the Publisher is also the owner of the profile (or Home page) from which it was launched; we therefore need to display the Self-Publisher to allow this user to publish